West or North–South. The BRICS collaboration reflects the ‘concert of civilizations’ than the ‘clash of civilizations’ (Observer Research Foundation 2017: 68).[14]

The political shaping of BRICS begun as early as 2006 during the UN General Assembly Session in New York, United States. It was the first of a series of high-level meetings among BRICS countries. Since then, BRICS has evolved into a multilateral grouping. The first cooperation among the BRICS group countries started with deputy ministers and heads of government agencies.

The BRIC acronym was first created by the Goldman Sachs economist Jim O’Neill in 2001 while projecting the growth rate of these countries. He foresaw these countries to have the potential to overtake other developed countries. O’Neill argued that the West should shift their economic policies toward the BRIC countries region, as these countries would have safety for advanced countries’ investments (O’Neill 2001). Furthermore, the World Bank report ‘World Development Indicators’ of 2021 claimed that China became the second-largest global economy, India became the sixth largest global economy, Russia became the eleventh largest global economy, and Brazil became the twelfth largest global economy. South Africa became the thirty-ninth largest economy (World Bank 2021). And that the BRICS countries have 43.03 percent of the world's population, 18 percent of the nominal GDP, 25 percent of the GDP per capita, 25.91 percent of the planet's land area (Reis 2013).

Russian President Putin was the first person to take the initiative to propel this group into a political group and coordinate the group to work toward more democratic world order, with the multipolarity concept in international relations (Akulov 2012). The first Summit was held in Yekaterinburg, Russia, in 2009 (Mielniczuk 2013). South Africa became an official member of BRICS during the Sanya Summit (Yan 2011). The tradition to hold an annual summit had been started in the year 2009. Every Summit took place with a specific theme and mainly stressed the prevailing global problems and lacunae in the international system. Since then, there have been eight summits held so far. (The thematic explanation of each Summit has been given below.) The first Summit was held in Yekaterinburg, Russia, in 2009. The second Summit was held in Brasilia, Brazil, in 2010, and the Third Summit was held in Sanya, China, in 2011. During Sanya Summit, South Africa officially became a member of the